

Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board

16 September 2025

WDID: 5A320101001

Jamie Little
Interim General Manager
Indian Valley Community Services District
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NOTICE OF APPLICABILITY (NOA), WATER QUALITY ORDER 2014-0153-DWQ-R5428, INDIAN VALLEY COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT, GREENVILLE WASTEWATER PONDS, GREENVILLE, PLUMAS COUNTY

Indian Valley Community Services District (Discharger) owns and operates the Greenville wastewater ponds located in Greenville, Plumas County (Facility). This Facility currently discharges and is enrolled under Waste Discharge Requirements (WDR) Order 99-046.

On 12 March 2019, Central Valley Regional Water Quality Board (Central Valley Water Board) requested a Report of Waste Discharge (ROWD) and an application for renewal of the WDR. A ROWD was submitted on 13 November 2019. At the time the ROWD was submitted, it was reported that the Facility discharged approximately 192,500 gallons of wastewater per day and maintained 570 service connections. The permitting process was delayed due to several factors, such as the COVID-19 pandemic and the Dixie Fire¹. The Dixie Fire destroyed a majority of the town of Greenville and damaged some of the wastewater system infrastructure, including the three lift stations. Two of the lift stations were replaced in 2022.

On 1 February 2024, the Discharger requested a fee reduction due to the following:

- The Dixie Fire destroyed a large portion of the town and as such, wastewater flows are greatly diminished.
- The rebuilding effort is underway but will take a significant number of years to complete.

¹ The Dixie Fire started on 13 July 2021 and burned approximately 963,000 acres in five counties: Butte, Plumas, Shasta, Lassen and Tehama. The fire was contained on 25 October 2021.

- Current post-Dixie Fire flows are approximately 45,000² gallons of wastewater per day.

Based on current conditions, the Facility treats and disposes of less than 100,000 gallons of wastewater per day and is therefore eligible for coverage under the general and specific conditions of State Water Resources Control Board (State Water Board) Water Quality Order 2014-0153-DWQ General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems (General Order). This letter serves as formal notice that the General Order is applicable to your facility and the wastewater discharge described below. You are hereby assigned General Order 2014-0153-DWQ-R5428 for your Facility.

You can also find the General Order on the [State Water Board's Adopted Orders](http://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf) web page (http://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf).

You should familiarize yourself with the entire General Order and its attachments, which prescribes mandatory discharge and monitoring requirements. Sampling, monitoring, and reporting requirements that are applicable to your treatment and disposal methods must be completed in accordance with the sections of the General Order and the attached Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP). This MRP was developed after consideration of your treatment system infrastructure and site conditions described in the attached Technical Memorandum.

REGULATORY BACKGROUND

The Discharger's wastewater treatment and disposal system is currently regulated under WDR Order 99-0463. Wastewater flows have been greatly reduced since the Dixie Fire, therefore an individual WDR Order is no longer necessary and may be covered under the General Order adopted on 23 September 2014.

FACILITY AND DESCRIPTION

Indian Valley Community Services District owns and operates the Facility, which is located east of Greenville, in Section 2, Township 26 North, Range 9 East, MDB&M (Assessor's Parcel No. 004-090-032 and 004-080-019). Wolf Creek is immediately south of the Facility; to the north, west and east are agricultural fields.

According to the 2019 ROWD, the Discharger owns and maintains six stabilization (treatment) ponds, covering approximately 28 acres. The wastewater receives no treatment before entering the first pond. Treatment in ponds consists of natural aeration and chemical decomposition. Treated wastewater leaves the ponds through evaporation

² The average daily wastewater flows reported for June 2025 were approximately 45,000 gallons of wastewater per day.

and infiltration. The ponds are operated in series with influent entering Pond 1, then to Pond 2 and to Pond 3, all of which represent the original ponds from 1959, along with Pond 4. Wastewater is routed to Ponds 5 and 6, constructed in 1995, via six-inch diameter PVC piping from either the Main or Backup lift stations, located immediately west of the ponds, at the entrance gate. The ROWD states that “Pond 4 is used for lift station overflow; influent which enters Pond 4 is returned to the lift station and the treatment ponds.” However, a pre-permit inspection conducted in 2024 revealed that Pond 4 was not a pond, but a field owned by a private entity.

The Facility has had issues with inflow and infiltration (I/I) since the Dixie Fire. During post-fire cleanup, damage to wastewater infrastructure (risers and cleanouts) occurred. Stormwater inflow into damaged sewer pipes has increased reported flow. The Facility plans to conduct smoke testing to locate damaged lines. Reported average daily flows in 2024 were approximately 52,900 gallons per day (gpd). However during the dry season (May through September), average daily flows were approximately 13,200 gpd. A recent survey conducted by the Discharger showed there are only 159 active sewers connections in Greenville. Per the Onsite Wastewater Treatment Systems Policy³, a “single-family dwelling unit” is expected to generate an average of 250 gpd of wastewater. Therefore, post-Dixie Fire, it is anticipated that approximately 39,750 gpd of wastewater will be discharged to the Facility.

This is an existing facility, therefore enrollment under the General Order is categorically exempt from the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) pursuant to California Code of Regulations, title 14, section 15301 which applies to ongoing or existing projects.

FACILITY SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS

The Discharger will maintain exclusive control over the discharge and shall comply with the terms and conditions of this NOA and the General Order 2014-0153-DWQ-R5428, with all attachments.

The General Order states in Section B.1.L that the discharger shall comply with the setbacks as described in Table 3. The following applicable setback requirements from Table 3, for which the Discharger shall comply, are summarized below:

³ 2023, Water Quality Control Policy for Siting, Design, Operation, and Maintenance of Onsite Wastewater Treatment Systems (OWTS Policy), State Water Resources Control Board, April 18.

The following table has been adapted from Table 3 of the General Order and only includes setback requirements for specific equipment or activities applicable to the subject facility. Table notes are not in alphabetical order due to the way they were formatted in the General Order.

Table 3: Summary of Wastewater System Setbacks

Equipment or Activity	Domestic Well	Flowing Stream (see a below)	Ephemeral Stream Drainage (see b below)	Property Line	Lake or Reservoir (see d. below)
Septic Tank, Aerobic Treatment Unit, Treatment System, or Collection System (see e below)	150 ft. (see y below) 100 ft (see o below) 50 ft (see c below)	50 ft. (see c below)	50 ft.	5 ft. (see c below) (see z below)	200 ft. (see w below) 50 ft (see c below)
Impoundment (undisinfected secondary recycled water) (see i below)	150 ft. (see s below)	150 ft.	150 ft.	50 ft.	200 ft.

Table Notes:

- a A flowing stream shall be measured from the ordinary high-water mark established by fluctuations of water elevation and indicated by characteristics such as shelving, changes in soil character, vegetation type, presence of litter or debris, or other appropriate means.
- b Ephemeral Stream Drainage denotes a surface water drainage feature that flows only after rain or snowmelt and does not have sufficient groundwater seepage (baseflow) to maintain a condition of flowing surface water. The drainage shall be measured from a line that defines the limit of the ordinary high-water mark (described in “a” above). Irrigation canals are not considered ephemeral streams drainage features. The ephemeral stream shall be a “losing stream” (discharging surface water to groundwater) at the proposed wastewater system site.
- c Setback established by California Plumbing Code, Table K-1.
- d Lake or reservoir boundary measured from the high-water line.

- e Septic Tank, Aerobic Treatment Unit, Treatment System, or Collection System addresses equipment located below ground or that impedes leak detection by routine visual inspection.
- i Undisinfected secondary recycled water is defined in California Code of Regulations, title 22, section 60301.900
- o California Well Standards, part II, section 8. Site-specific conditions may allow reduced setback or require an increased setback. See discussion in Well Standards.
- s Setback established by California Code of Regulations, title 22, section 60310(d).
- w Setback established by the Onsite Wastewater Treatment System Policy, section 7.5.5.
- y Setback established by Onsite Wastewater Treatment System Policy, section 7.5.6.
- z Collection system to property line setback is not applicable.

The General Order also states in Section E.4.a that the discharger shall comply with the MRP issued with the NOA. The MRP issued with this NOA requires the monitoring of the Facility's solids disposal and pond systems.

Failure to comply with the requirements in the documents could result in an enforcement action as authorized by provisions of the California Water Code. Discharge of wastes other than those described in this NOA is prohibited. If the method of waste disposal changes from that described in this NOA, you must submit a new Report of Waste Discharge describing the new operation.

The required annual fee specified in the annual billing from the State Water Board shall be paid until this NOA is officially terminated. You must notify this office in writing if the discharge regulated by the General Order ceases, so that we may terminate coverage and avoid unnecessary billing.

Facility Information

Facility Name	Greenville Wastewater Ponds
Program	WDR
Order Number	R5-2014-0153-R5428
WDID	5A320101001
Design Flow	50,000
Threat and Complexity	2C
Monitoring Requirements	Yes

Billing Information

Name	Indian Valley Community Services District
Contact	Patti Nordt
Email	pnordt@indianvalleycsd.com
Address	PO Box 160, Crescent Mill, CA 95934
Phone	530-284-7224

The Central Valley Water Board is transitioning to the paperless office system. Dischargers must submit reports (both technical and monitoring reports) to the State Water Board's GeoTracker database over the internet in portable document format (PDF). The Discharger shall follow the applicable Electronic Submittal of Information (ESI) requirements under the Facility-specific **Global Identification Number WDR100031680** at the [GeoTracker](https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/esi/login.asp) database.
(<https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/esi/login.asp>)

Documents that are 50MB or larger should be transferred to a disc and mailed to the appropriate regional water board office, in this case
364 Knollcrest Drive, Suite 205, Redding, CA 96002.

To ensure that your submittals are routed to the appropriate staff, the following information block should be included in any email used to transmit documents to this office:

Program: Non-15

WDID: 5A320101001

Facility Name: Greenville Wastewater Ponds

Order: 2014-0153-DWQ-R5428

Please note that WDRs Order 99-046 is proposed to be rescinded at the 11/12 December 2025 board meeting of the Central Valley Water Board. Upon rescission of your individual WDRs, coverage for your facility under the General Order shall become applicable subject to this Notice of Applicability.

If you have any questions regarding submitting an updated report of waste discharge, making changes to your permitted operations, compliance or enforcement please contact Melissa Buciak by phone at (530) 224-4854, by email at melissa.buciak@waterboards.ca.gov, or at the footer address located on the first page of this correspondence.

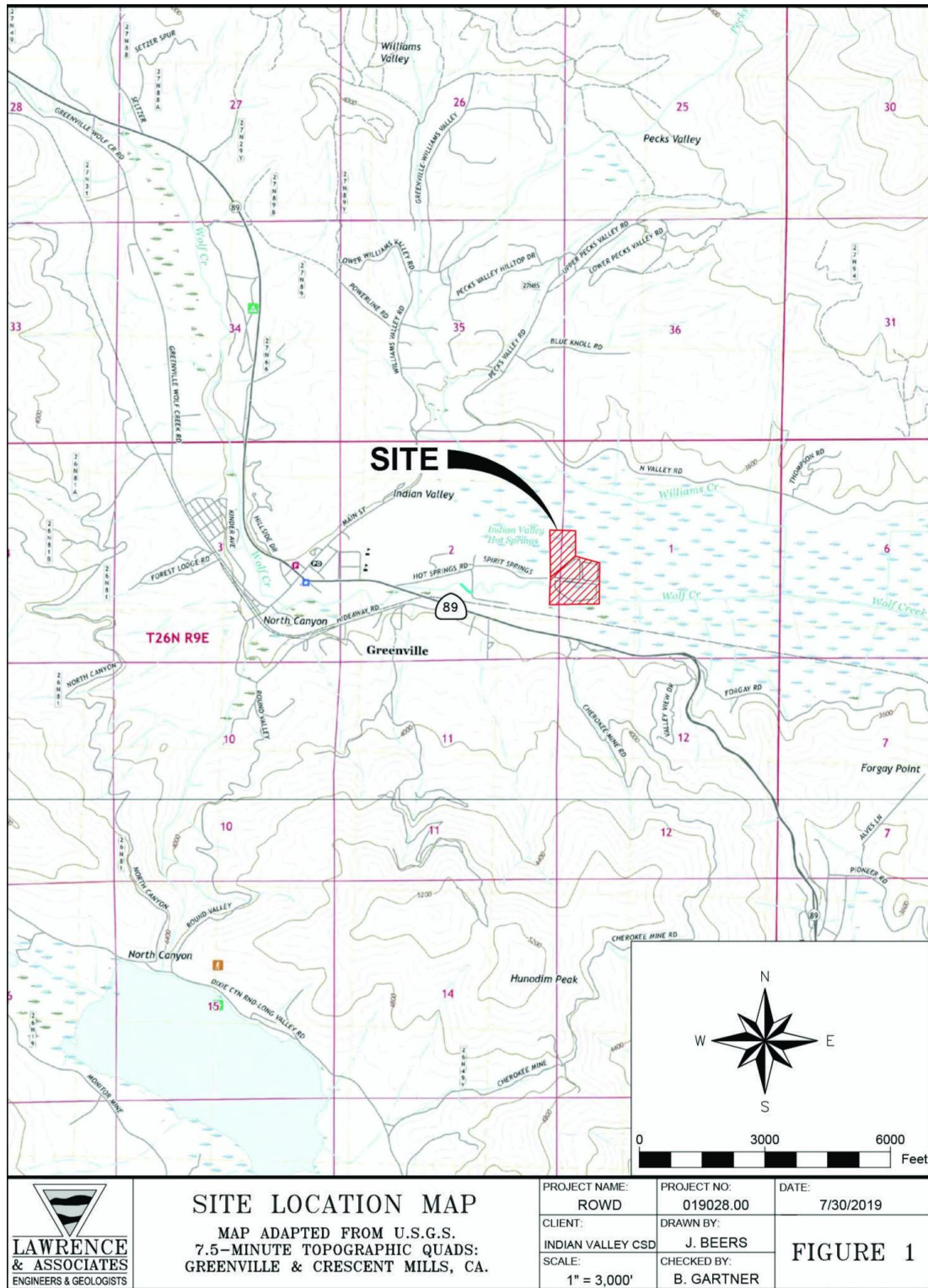
For PATRICK PULUPA, Executive Officer

MAB: cc

Enclosures: Attachment A – Site Location Map
Attachment B – Facility Map
Technical Memorandum
Monitoring and Reporting Program
General Order 2014-0153-DWQ

cc electronically
w/out enclosures: Pat Sanders, Plumas County Environmental Health, Quincy
Stephanie Torres, State Water Board, Sacramento
Christopher Moskal, SWRCB, Office of Chief Counsel, Sacramento

Attachment A Site Location Map



Attachment B Facility Map

